

setting aside that 10 percent of your income, the sooner you start to develop those powers for good use in your life. But here's another trick to preserving and growing your Secret 10: Don't tell anyone about it! Not your mother, not your brother, no one. (You will have to tell your future significant other, because you have to disclose this information during the prenuptial process. And you *will* listen to Uncle Kevin and get a prenup.) Because the more people who know about your Secret 10, the more vulnerable it is to be spent. By the time you get married, that Secret 10 will be significant enough that you'll want to protect it always.

Imagine a gold box with your name on it buried somewhere deep in the vaults of your trusted financial institution. Inside that box, your money is growing, changing, and waiting for you to put it to good use. Perhaps your Secret 10 will become a significant down payment on a house, or a primary source of income through a critical illness. Your Secret 10 might stay down there most of your life, coming to your rescue when you're old and gray and your kids are contemplating putting you in a nursing home. But look, you have enough money to take care of yourself in the manner that you prefer. It's your money. It's your Secret 10.

Money Mistake: You Don't Have the Discipline to Save Your Secret 10

THE FIX: MAKE SAVING AS IMPORTANT AS BRUSHING YOUR TEETH

If you are a parent of older kids, you may remember how hard it was to get your kids to brush their teeth when they were young. My mother told me I hated doing it. I used to run screaming from the bathroom. I don't remember this, but she said it was torture even getting the brush past my lips. Why did I hate brushing my teeth? I don't remember, but I was always the type of kid who didn't like being told what to do, even if it was good for me. *Especially* when it was good for me. (I'm still like that, by the way.) But here's the thing: While I don't remember those torturous tooth-brushing sessions, I do